

barriers to be overcome – one of these being that seeing a professional trained in both fields comes with a financial cost, which may be counter-intuitive for some. It comes down to the age-old question of whether an initial financial investment will pay dividends in the future and, as with all therapy, it's not a magical solution.

Financial therapy has yet to make its way to the UK mainstream, but financial coaching – a softer practice that explores some of the emotional elements of money – is growing in popularity. For a 2016 *Guardian* piece, journalist Nione Meakin spoke to financial coach Simonne Gnessen about her difficulties in managing her finances, writing: 'Talking about money with a stranger feels both exposing and liberating. It's a subject that provokes strong emotions, but we rarely discuss it even with our closest friends. Perhaps financial therapy just offers a much-needed platform to discuss these feelings with someone who won't judge us.' She concludes that, for her, looking into these underlying feelings and associations is interesting, but that it becomes useful when patterns of harmful behaviour are uncovered, especially as we tend to repeat mistakes that we make in other areas of our lives.⁷

Ellie Austin-Williams is a financial coach, and trained under Simonne Gnessen to get her certification. She works with people to help them to understand their relationship with money better, and to overcome some of the behaviours that might be sabotaging their financial wellbeing.